Untermenschen."

Léa's knees wobbled, and she gripped Rose's arm to hold herself steady. Those poor naked women had been forced to line up before men, who shaved their heads and private parts, then lathered a cream on raw skin that visibly made the women wince with pain. It was an image seared in her mind, feeling their distress and humiliation as if the same was being done to her.

"*Untermenschen*?" Rose asked, confused.

"*Indésirables*," Lagerführer Klein said. "Poles and Russians. They're dirty, disease-ridden swine." She crossed her arms at her chest. "We keep them separate from the general population. It's forbidden for other workers to mix with them. Understand?"

"*Ja*." Rose swallowed, looking away.

All sorts of thoughts jangled inside Léa's head but it came down to one—hatred was the fuel running the engine of war—and she could see it here in operation, like some well-written play where everyone had a role to follow to reinforce the script.

Hatred wasn't natural. It had to be diffused, institutionalized, enforced: hatred for how people look, the language they speak, the country they come from, the religion they worship. Now that Léa saw the truth, with such clarity, she couldn't look away; it had lodged itself deep inside her. And she knew that somehow she must fight this hatred with everything she had, and even if it only changed the life of one person, it would be worth it. It was what every person should do; it seemed so simple and clear, like a musical note ringing true. And yet, somehow it wasn't true here, where hatred was the hardest thing of all to conquer.

Lagerführer Klein motioned for her to move forward to the table.

Léa pressed her thumb on the ink pot and then on the empty square printed on the small gray card. She rolled it from left to right, as the man showed her, then did the same for her index finger. As she moved to the table for her photograph, her gaze fell once more on the women being shaved, and her resolve deepened. All the while, she sensed the watchful, persistent gaze of Lagerführer Klein on her.

Rose followed. As Léa watched her sister, she realized that this fight would take cunning and preparation, because her opponents were everywhere, waiting to take out anyone who spoke up. She would have to